THE JOPETNAH FOUNDATION

Gender Equality and Social Inclusion Policy

Building Whole Communities, One Life at a Time.

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Executive Summary

The Jopetnah Foundation (TJF) believes that sustainable development is only possible when all people have equal opportunities to participate, contribute and benefit from social and economic progress.

Gender inequality, discrimination, disability barriers and social exclusion can prevent individuals and communities from achieving their full potential.

This Gender Equality and Social Inclusion (GESI) Policy establishes TJF's commitment to promoting equality, diversity, dignity, accessibility and inclusive participation across all programmes, operations and partnerships.

1. Purpose

This Policy aims to:

- Promote gender equality.
- Strengthen social inclusion.
- Prevent discrimination.
- Increase participation of marginalized groups.
- Improve accessibility of programmes.
- Support equitable development outcomes.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to:

- Board members.
- Employees.
- Volunteers.
- Consultants.
- Partners.
- Programme participants.
- Communities engaged by TJF.

It applies across:

- Programme design.
- Implementation.
- Monitoring.
- Workplace practices.
- Partnerships.
- Communications.

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3. Policy Commitment

TJF commits to:

- Respecting human dignity.
- Promoting equal opportunity.
- Challenging discrimination.
- Removing barriers to participation.
- Supporting vulnerable and marginalized groups.
- Integrating inclusion into decision-making.

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4. Key Definitions

Gender Equality

Equal rights, responsibilities and opportunities for all genders.

Social Inclusion

Ensuring that individuals and groups have meaningful participation in society and access to opportunities.

Marginalized Groups

Individuals or communities who experience barriers due to social, economic, physical or cultural factors.

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5. Guiding Principles

Equality and Fairness

Everyone should have equal access to opportunities and services.

Non-Discrimination

TJF prohibits discrimination based on:

- Gender.
- Age.
- Disability.
- Background.
- Social status.
- Other protected characteristics.

Participation

All groups should have opportunities to influence decisions affecting them.

Accessibility

Programmes should remove barriers preventing participation.

Empowerment

TJF seeks to strengthen people's ability to make decisions and improve their lives.

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6. Gender Equality Commitments

TJF promotes:

Equal Participation

Programmes should encourage participation of all genders.

Women's Empowerment

TJF supports:

- Leadership opportunities.
- Economic empowerment.
- Skills development.
- Education access.
- Decision-making participation.

Protection Against Gender-Based Violence

TJF works to prevent and respond to:

- Violence.
- Exploitation.
- Harassment.
- Harmful practices.

Gender-Responsive Programming

Programmes should consider:

- Different needs.
- Different experiences.
- Different barriers.

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7. Social Inclusion Commitments

TJF promotes inclusion of:

Persons with Disabilities

Through:

- Accessible programme locations.
- Inclusive communication.
- Reasonable accommodation.

Youth

Through:

- Skills development.
- Leadership opportunities.
- Entrepreneurship support.

Older Persons

Through:

- Respectful participation.
- Appropriate support approaches.

Vulnerable Communities

Through:

- Targeted support.
- Community participation.
- Protection mechanisms.

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8. Inclusive Programme Design

All TJF programmes should consider:

Gender Analysis

Understanding:

- Roles.
- Responsibilities.
- Barriers.
- Opportunities.

Inclusion Assessment

Identifying:

- Who participates.
- Who may be excluded.

- What barriers exist.

Inclusive Indicators

Programs should measure:

- Participation by different groups.
- Benefits received.
- Changes achieved.

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9. Inclusive Community Engagement

TJF shall encourage:

- Representation of diverse groups.
- Safe consultation spaces.
- Accessible communication.
- Participation of marginalized voices.

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10. Workplace Equality

TJF promotes:

- Equal employment opportunities.
- Fair recruitment.
- Professional respect.
- Inclusive workplace culture.

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11. Prevention of Discrimination and Harassment

TJF does not tolerate:

- Discrimination.
- Bullying.
- Sexual harassment.
- Exclusionary practices.

Concerns shall be handled through established reporting mechanisms.

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12. Accessibility Standards

TJF should consider:

Physical Accessibility

Examples:

- Accessible venues.
- Safe facilities.
- Appropriate infrastructure.

Communication Accessibility

Examples:

- Simple language.
- Translation support.
- Alternative communication methods.

Digital Accessibility

Examples:

- Accessible digital platforms.
- Inclusive technology solutions.

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13. Monitoring Gender and Inclusion Outcomes

Indicators may include:

Indicator	Measurement
Female participation rate	Percentage
Disability inclusion rate	Percentage
Vulnerable groups reached	Number
Inclusive programme assessments completed	Percentage
Satisfaction levels	Survey results

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14. Roles and Responsibilities

Executive Director

Responsible for:

- Organizational commitment.
- Strategic leadership.

Programmes Department

Responsible for:

- Integrating GESI principles.
- Inclusive programme delivery.

Human Resources Department

Responsible for:

- Workplace equality.
- Staff awareness.

MEAL Department

Responsible for:

- Measuring inclusion outcomes.
- Analysing participation data.

All Staff and Partners

Responsible for:

- Respectful behaviour.
- Supporting inclusion.
- Reporting discrimination.

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15. Training and Awareness

TJF shall provide training on:

- Gender equality.
- Disability inclusion.
- Diversity.
- Unconscious bias.
- Inclusive communication.

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16. Compliance

Failure to comply may result in:

- Corrective action.
- Additional training.
- Disciplinary measures.
- Partnership review.

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17. Review

This Policy shall be reviewed:

- Every three years.
- Following programme learning.
- Following changes in inclusion standards.

Conclusion

Equality and inclusion are essential foundations for sustainable development.

By promoting participation, removing barriers and empowering diverse communities, The Jopetnah Foundation advances a future where everyone has the opportunity to contribute and thrive.

> **Inclusive development means ensuring that every person has a voice, an opportunity and a place in building a better future.**